Lesson 18

THE CIVIL GOVERNMENT

Aim: To present the Biblical View concerning Civil Government

Intro:

How should a Christian relate to civil Government? Today, with the spreading influence of rebellion and indifference to civil government, Christians sometimes are affected and put in a dilemma: whether to be submissive to government authorities or not. What should be our attitude as believers to civil government?

I. What is a Civil Government?

Civil - of, pertaining to, or consisting of citizens: civil life; civil society.

Citizens –

1.a native or naturalized member of a state or nation who owes allegiance to its government and is entitled to its protection (distinguished from alien).

2.an inhabitant of a city or town, especially one entitled to its privileges or franchises.

Government -

1. the political direction and control exercised over the actions of the members, citizens, or inhabitants of communities, societies, and states; direction of the affairs of a state, community, etc.

   ; political administration: Government is necessary to the existence of civilized society.

2. the form or system of rule by which a state, community,

   etc., is governed: monarchical government; episcopal government.

II. Biblical Perspective on Civil Government?

A. Civil Government is instituted by God. Romans 13:1

B. Civil Government is an instrument to fulfill Divine Office. Romans 13:2

C. Civil Government is expected to rule according to Divine will. Romans 13:4

III. The Government's Obligation to the Society

A. To Keep Peace. Romans 13:4

B. To maintain and preserve Order - Romans 13:4

C. To Uphold Justice. Romans 13:3

IV. Christian Attitude and Obligation to Civil Government

A. Voluntary submission. Rom. 13:1,6, 1Pet. 2:13

B. Obedience. Romans 13:5

C. Respect. Romans 13:7, 1Peter 2:17

D. Tribute

What is a Tribute?

1. a stated sum or other valuable consideration paid by one sovereign or state to another in acknowledgment of subjugation or as the price of peace, security, protection, or the like.
2. a rent, tax, or the like, as that paid by a subject to a sovereign.

3. any exacted or enforced payment or contribution.

4. obligation or liability to make such payment. Romans 13:7

E. Pray. 1 Tim. 2:1,2

Conclusion

A. As Christians, therefore, we should develop an attitude of respect and submission to our civil Government or authorities.

B. We may differ in opinion regarding our Government leaders, yet the command is clear to respect and pray for them.